

Lead Scraper — Setup Guide

Get the weekly lead scraper running on your own Mac, start to finish.

Be the name they know. — Forward is the only way. We forge on.

This walks you through everything, click by click. No coding required — you'll copy a few things and click some buttons. By the end you'll have a **Forge Leads** icon on your Desktop that pulls fresh, scored leads in your region whenever you want them.

🕒 Plan for about 45–75 minutes



Two things Teo sets up for you first. Before you start, make sure Teo has (1) **added you as a collaborator** on the GitHub code repository (you'll get an email invite — accept it), and (2) is **free for ~20 minutes** while you do Part 4 (the Google setup). That part is the fiddly one, and having him on a quick screen-share makes it painless. Everything else you can do solo.

The big picture (what each part does)

- **Part 1** — Install two free tools (Python & GitHub Desktop).
- **Part 2** — Download the code to your Mac.
- **Part 3** — Run the one-click installer (builds everything + your Desktop icon).
- **Part 4** — Get your Google keys (the longer part — Teo on standby).
- **Part 5** — Plug your keys in.
- **Part 6** — First run: sign into Google, watch it work.
- **Part 7** — How to run it every week.

1 Install two free tools

You need two free apps. Install both, then come back.

A) Python 3.12

- 1 Go to python.org/downloads/release/python-3120.
- 2 Scroll to the bottom, under **Files**, click “**macOS 64-bit universal2 installer**” to download the **.pkg** file.
- 3 Open the downloaded file and click through **Continue** → **Continue** → **Agree** → **Install** (enter your Mac password if asked).

B) GitHub Desktop

- 1 Go to desktop.github.com and click **Download for macOS**.
- 2 Open the downloaded file and drag **GitHub Desktop** into your **Applications** folder.
- 3 Open GitHub Desktop and click **Sign in to GitHub.com**. Log in with your GitHub account (the same email Teo invited).



What's GitHub? It's just where the code lives online — like a shared Google Drive, but for software. GitHub Desktop is the friendly app that copies it to your Mac.

2 Download the code

- 1 First, accept Teo's invite: check your email for an invitation to the **forge-local-lead-scraper** repository and click **Accept**. (If you don't see it, ask Teo to re-send it.)
- 2 In **GitHub Desktop**, go to **File → Clone repository**.
- 3 Pick the **forge-local-lead-scraper** repo from the list. For **Local path**, the default is fine — but note where it's putting the folder (usually **Documents/GitHub/forge-local-lead-scraper**). Click **Clone**.
- 4 When it finishes, click **Repository → Show in Finder**. A folder window opens — keep it open, you'll use it next.



"Clone" just means "download your own copy." That folder on your Mac is now *yours* — your keys and leads stay on your machine.

3 Run the one-click installer

This builds everything automatically and puts the **Forge Leads** icon on your Desktop. It's safe to run more than once.

- 1 In the folder from Part 2, find the file named **Setup Forge Local.command** and **double-click it**. A black Terminal window opens and starts working.
- 2 If macOS blocks it with *"cannot be opened because it is from an unidentified developer,"* **right-click** the file → **Open** → **Open** in the popup. (You only do this once.)
- 3 Watch it run through steps 1–4. It checks Python, installs what it needs, and creates your Desktop icon. When you see 🎉 **Setup is done,** you can read the two reminders and close the window.



If it says **"Python 3.12 is not installed"**, go back and finish Part 1A, then double-click Setup again.

You'll now have a **Forge Leads** icon on your Desktop. It won't fully work yet — you still need your Google keys (next).

4 Get your Google keys

This is the longest part. Take it slow. This is the best time to have Teo on a screen-share.

You're getting **two things** from Google: an **API key** (lets the tool look up businesses) and an **OAuth client file** (lets it create your Google Sheets and email your report). Both are free.

4.1 — Create your project

- 1 Go to console.cloud.google.com and sign in with your work Google account.
- 2 At the very top, click the **project dropdown** (says "Select a project") → **New Project**.
- 3 Name it **Forge Local Leads** → **Create**. Wait a few seconds, then make sure that project is selected in the top dropdown.

4.2 — Turn on the Places API

- 1 In the search bar at the top, type **Places API (New)** and click it in the results.
- 2 Click the blue **Enable** button. (If it asks you to enable billing first, do Step 4.3 below, then come back and Enable.)

4.3 — Turn on billing (required, but you won't be charged for normal use)



Google requires a credit card on file to use the maps data — but normal weekly scraping stays inside Google's **\$200/month free credit**. A typical week costs a few cents. You will not be charged for using this the way we use it.

- 1 In the top search bar, type **Billing** and open it.
- 2 Click **Link a billing account** → **Create billing account**, and follow the prompts to enter your card details.

- 3 Make sure the billing account is linked to your **Forge Local Leads** project.

4.4 — Create your API key

- 1 Top search bar → type **Credentials** → open the **APIs & Services** → **Credentials** page.
- 2 Click **+ Create Credentials** → **API key**.
- 3 A box pops up with your new key. Click **Copy** and paste it somewhere safe for a minute (a sticky note or Notes app). It looks like **AIzaSy...**
- 4 (Recommended) Click **Edit API key** → under **API restrictions** choose **Restrict key** → check **Places API (New)** → **Save**. This keeps the key safe.

4.5 — Set up the OAuth consent screen

- 1 Top search bar → **OAuth consent screen** → open it.
- 2 Choose **External** → **Create**.
- 3 Fill in **App name** (**Forge Local**), **User support email** (yours), and **Developer contact email** (yours). Click **Save and Continue** through the next screens — you can skip "Scopes."
- 4 On the **Test users** step, click **+ Add Users**, type **your own Google email**, and add it. **Save and Continue**.



Leaving it in "Testing" mode is correct. The only side effect: about **once a week** Google will ask you to sign in again (one click). That's normal — see Part 7.

4.6 — Create & download the OAuth client file

- 1 Go back to **Credentials** (top search bar → Credentials).
- 2 Click **+ Create Credentials** → **OAuth client ID**.

- 3 For **Application type**, choose **Desktop app**. Name it **Forge Local Desktop** → **Create**.
- 4 In the popup, click **Download JSON**. A file lands in your **Downloads** folder (named something like **client_secret_...json**).
- 5 **Rename that file to exactly** **oauth-client.json** (keep the **.json** ending). You'll move it in the next part.

5 Plug your keys in

Two quick drops into your project folder (the one from Part 2 — reopen it in Finder if you closed it).

5.1 — Drop in your OAuth file

- 1 In your project folder, open the **credentials** folder.
- 2 Drag the `oauth-client.json` file you just renamed (from Downloads) **into** that **credentials** folder.

5.2 — Add your API key & email

- 1 In the project folder, find the file named `.env` (just ".env", nothing before the dot). **Right-click it → Open With → TextEdit.**
- 2 Find the line `GOOGLE_MAPS_API_KEY=` and paste your API key right after the `=` (no spaces, no quotes).
- 3 Find the line `REPORT_EMAIL=` and type your work email right after the `=`.
- 4 **Save** (⌘ + S) and close TextEdit. Leave the other lines exactly as they are.

```
GOOGLE_MAPS_API_KEY=AIzaSyYourKeyHere
REPORT_EMAIL=neema@forge.local.app
```

⚠ Can't see the `.env` file? In Finder press **⌘ + Shift + . (period)** to show hidden files. Press it again later to re-hide them.

6

First run — sign in and watch it work

- 1 Double-click the **Forge Leads** icon on your Desktop. A Terminal window opens with a menu.
- 2 If macOS blocks it ("unidentified developer"), open **System Settings → Privacy & Security**, scroll down, and click **Open Anyway**. (One time only.)
- 3 At the menu, type **2** (Configure today's run) to pick your **state**, **niche**, and how many leads — or type **1** to run with the defaults. Press **Return**.
- 4 **The first time only:** your web browser pops open asking you to sign into Google. Choose your account → if you see a "Google hasn't verified this app" warning, click **Continue** (it's your own app) → click **Allow**. The browser will say "authentication flow has completed" — close it.
- 5 Back in Terminal, watch it scrape → find emails → score → build your Google Sheet → email you the report. It prints a **Sheet link** at the end.



That's it — you're live. Open the Sheet link, or check your inbox for the report. Leads are color-coded by how much they need us (🔴 hottest first), with phone *and* email where we could find one.



About the Email column: roughly 1 in 3 businesses with a website will have an email we can pull — the rest you reach by phone. A blank email is normal and honest, not a bug. We never guess or make up addresses.

7 Running it every week

- 1 Double-click **Forge Leads** on your Desktop.
- 2 Type **2** to set this week's region/niche (or **1** to reuse last week's), press **Return**.
- 3 If Google asks you to sign in again, do it (one click — see note). Then let it run and open your Sheet.



The weekly sign-in is expected. Because the app is in “Testing” mode, Google logs you out about once a week. When that happens, the browser just pops open again — pick your account, **Allow**, done. Nothing is broken.

Troubleshooting

What you see	What to do
"cannot be opened — unidentified developer"	Right-click the file → Open → Open . For the Desktop icon: System Settings → Privacy & Security → Open Anyway . One time each.
"command not found: python"	You're typing in the wrong place — just use the Forge Leads Desktop icon, which handles this for you.
Browser keeps asking me to sign in	Normal — about once a week (Part 7). One click and you're back.
"GOOGLE_MAPS_API_KEY not found"	Your <code>.env</code> is missing the key, or wasn't saved. Redo Part 5.2 and make sure you pressed Save.
API error about billing / "REQUEST_DENIED"	Billing isn't linked or Places API (New) isn't enabled. Recheck Parts 4.2 and 4.3.
Lots of blank emails	Expected — only ~1 in 3 sites expose an email. Use the phone number for the rest.
My state or niche isn't in the list	The menu only shows regions/niches set up in the config. Ask Teo to add yours — it's a one-line change on his end.
Anything else	Screenshot it and send it to Teo. Don't guess — a 2-minute message saves an hour.

Plain-English glossary

Word	What it actually means
Terminal	The black text window. You mostly just watch it; the icon opens it for you.
Repository ("repo")	The folder of code, shared online via GitHub.
Clone	Download your own copy of that folder to your Mac.
API key	A password-like code that lets the tool look up business data from Google.
OAuth	The "Sign in with Google" permission that lets the tool make your Sheets & send your report.
.env file	A little settings file where your key and email live (only on your Mac).



Stuck for more than a few minutes? Message Teo. This is a one-time setup — once it's running, your weekly routine is just: double-click, pick a region, go.

Forge Local — Lead Scraper Setup Guide · Internal use only
Be the name they know. Forward is the only way. We forge on.